

MILENA SYNEK

(408) 507-8509 | mks9879@nyu.edu | New York, NY | linkedin.com/in/milena-synek-696a962a9

EDUCATION

New York University

Expected May 2027

BA in Computer Science | Presidential Honors Scholar | GPA: 3.81/4.0

Relevant Coursework: Data Structures, Algorithms, Computer Systems Organization, Operating Systems, Linear Algebra, Web Development, Computer Vision, Machine Learning

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, Java, JavaScript, SQL, Bash, C, HTML/CSS, PHP

Frameworks/Tools: React, React Native, Vue.js, Flask, Firebase, PostgreSQL, Git, GitHub Actions, Datadog, Google Apps Script, Unix

EXPERIENCE

The New York Times — Backend Engineering Intern

June 2026 – Aug. 2026

- Built a live user-health dashboard in Datadog, working with engineering leadership to define SLIs for critical user journeys; ranked in the top 10% of internal dashboards by usage and used during live incidents to guide business decisions.
- Productionized an internal Operating Review app, an internal platform tracking operational maturity for critical services: migrated it from SQLite to AWS RDS Postgres and built a self-service flow for service owners.
- Added observability from scratch (custom metrics, RUM, PagerDuty alerting, and rebuilt a fragile processing pipeline into a reliable, monitored scheduled job.
- Joined major-incident bridge calls, assisted chaos tests on payment infrastructure, and load-tested services for the SRE readiness program ahead of high-traffic events like elections.

NYU College of Dentistry — Research Assistant (Prof. Craig Kapp)

May 2026 – Aug. 2026

- Built internal tools for a psychology research team studying decision-making in legal cases; piloted using Claude Code to develop a Google Sheets Apps Script application, streamlining case investigations for ~30 staff and student researchers.
- Developed an AI-powered Electron app that summarizes and rates reports audited by QA reviewers, assisting in and double-checking the review process.

Pimic — Software Intern

May 2025 – Aug. 2025

- Automated chip-level noise reduction tests with Bash scripts, saving ~3–5 hours of manual QA time per week and improving metric reliability.
- Simulated an AI chip's instruction pipeline in Python, including transformer-specific operations like rotary positional embeddings (RoPE), to inform hardware/software design decisions and optimize processing logic.

NYU Courant — Tutor

Sep. 2024 – Present

- Support professors in teaching Python fundamentals to ~100 students in Intro to Computer Programming, providing 1:1 debugging and conceptual support.

iD Tech Camps — Instructor

June 2025 – Aug. 2025

- Taught week-long courses in Python, AI fundamentals, and Java/Minecraft modding to students aged 10–17, guiding them through core programming concepts via hands-on projects.

PROJECTS

Restaurant Battle | React Native, Flask, SQL, Google Places API

- Built a full-stack app with a small team using the Google Places API to recommend nearby restaurants, with a gamified swipe UI and a database for saved places and login info.
- Presented the project to an audience of ~50 students, developers, and industry professionals.

Fridge Buddy | React, MongoDB, Google Gemini, Flask

- Architected a browser utility that catalogs users' fridge contents and, through the Gemini API, generates recipe recommendations.
- Designed custom GUI elements and a form system that made recording and isolating specific ingredients faster and more organized.

INTERESTS

Ballet, making bread, hiking, and solving crossword puzzles